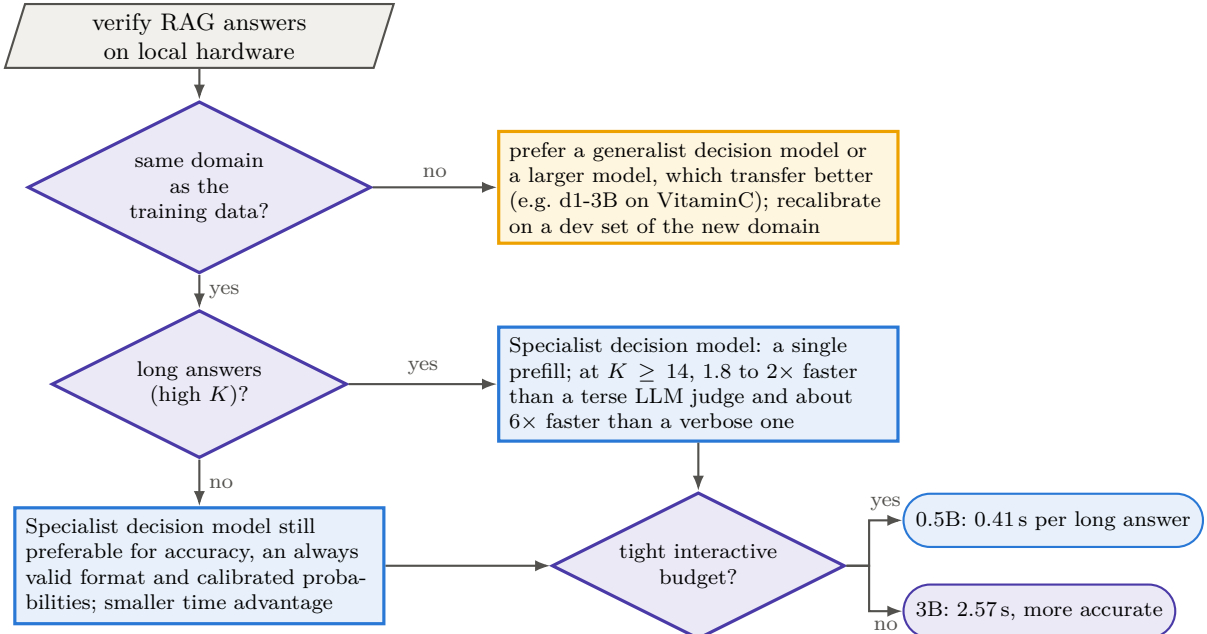

verify RAG answers on local hardware
same domain as the training data?
no
prefer a generalist decision model or a larger model, which transfer better (e.g. d1-3B on VitaminC); recalibrate on a dev set of the new domain
yes
long answers (high K)?
yes
Specialist decision model: a single prefill; at $K \geq 14$, 1.8 to 2× faster than a terse LLM judge and about 6× faster than a verbose one
no
Specialist decision model still preferable for accuracy, an always valid format and calibrated probabilities; smaller time advantage
tight interactive budget?
yes
0.5B: 0.41 s per long answer
no
3B: 2.57 s, more accurate